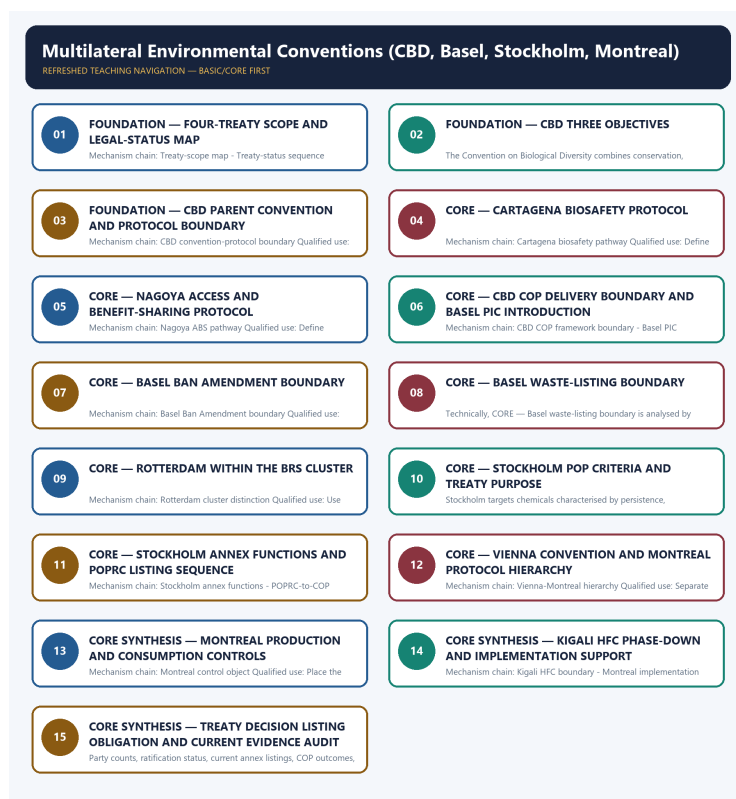


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Multilateral Environmental Conventions (CBD, Basel, Stockholm, Montreal) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Multilateral Environmental Conventions (CBD, Basel, Stockholm, Montreal) - Solved Practice Workbook	5
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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	5
---------------------------------	----------

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Treaty-scope map?	5
Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Treaty-scope map?	5
Q3. Which statement uses Treaty-scope map without changing its scale, parameter or status?	5
Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Treaty-scope map?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Treaty-status sequence?	6
Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Treaty-status sequence?	6
Q7. Which statement uses Treaty-status sequence without changing its scale, parameter or status?	7
Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Treaty-status sequence?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies CBD three objectives?	7
Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD three objectives?	7
Q11. Which statement uses CBD three objectives without changing its scale, parameter or status?	8
Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD three objectives?	8
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies CBD convention-protocol boundary?	8
Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD convention-protocol boundary?	9
Q15. Which statement uses CBD convention-protocol boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	9
Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD convention-protocol boundary?	9
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Cartagena biosafety pathway?	10
Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Cartagena biosafety pathway?	10
Q19. Which statement uses Cartagena biosafety pathway without changing its scale, parameter or status?	10
Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cartagena biosafety pathway?	10
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Nagoya ABS pathway?	11
Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Nagoya ABS pathway?	11
Q23. Which statement uses Nagoya ABS pathway without changing its scale, parameter or status?	11
Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nagoya ABS pathway?	12
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies CBD COP framework boundary?	12
Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD COP framework boundary?	12
Q27. Which statement uses CBD COP framework boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	12

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD COP framework boundary?	13
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Basel PIC mechanism?	13
Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel PIC mechanism?	13
Q31. Which statement uses Basel PIC mechanism without changing its scale, parameter or status?	14
Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel PIC mechanism?	14
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Basel Ban Amendment boundary?	14
Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel Ban Amendment boundary?	14
Q35. Which statement uses Basel Ban Amendment boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	15
Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel Ban Amendment boundary?	15
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Basel waste-listing boundary?	15
Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel waste-listing boundary?	16
Q39. Which statement uses Basel waste-listing boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	16
Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel waste-listing boundary?	16
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Rotterdam cluster distinction?	16
Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Rotterdam cluster distinction?	17
Q43. Which statement uses Rotterdam cluster distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?	17
Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rotterdam cluster distinction?	17
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Stockholm POP identity?	18
Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Stockholm POP identity?	18
Q47. Which statement uses Stockholm POP identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?	18
Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Stockholm POP identity?	18
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Stockholm annex functions?	19
Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Stockholm annex functions?	19
Q51. Which statement uses Stockholm annex functions without changing its scale, parameter or status?	19
Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Stockholm annex functions?	20
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies POPRC-to-COP sequence?	20
Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of POPRC-to-COP sequence?	20
Q55. Which statement uses POPRC-to-COP sequence without changing its scale, parameter or status?	20
Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about POPRC-to-COP sequence?	21
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?	21
Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?	21
Q59. Which statement uses Vienna-Montreal hierarchy without changing its scale, parameter or status?	21

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?	22
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Montreal control object?	22
Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Montreal control object?	22
Q63. Which statement uses Montreal control object without changing its scale, parameter or status?	23
Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Montreal control object?	23
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Kigali HFC boundary?	23
Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Kigali HFC boundary?	23
Q67. Which statement uses Kigali HFC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	24
Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Kigali HFC boundary?	24
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Montreal implementation support?	24
Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Montreal implementation support?	25
Q71. Which statement uses Montreal implementation support without changing its scale, parameter or status?	25
Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Montreal implementation support?	25
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Decision-obligation boundary?	26
Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Decision-obligation boundary?	26
Q75. Which statement uses Decision-obligation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	26
Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Decision-obligation boundary?	26
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Current evidence boundary?	27
Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Current evidence boundary?	27
Q79. Which statement uses Current evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	27
Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current evidence boundary?	28
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	28
AUDITED CBD, BIOSAFETY, ABS, WASTE, POP AND OZONE PYQ OWNERSHIP	28
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	28
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III	30
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	31
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	35
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	37
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	40
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	43
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	46

Multilateral Environmental Conventions (CBD, Basel, Stockholm, Montreal) - Solved Practice Workbook

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Treaty-scope map?

A. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. B. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. C. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. D. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.

Answer: A. Explanation: CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Treaty-scope map?

A. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. B. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. C. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. D. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty.

Answer: B. Explanation: CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Treaty-scope map without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. B. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. C. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. D. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval.

Answer: C. Explanation: CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Treaty-scope map?

A. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. B. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. C. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. D. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Answer: D. Explanation: CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Treaty-status sequence?

A. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. B. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. C. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. D. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty.

Answer: A. Explanation: Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Treaty-status sequence?

A. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. B. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. C. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. D. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval.

Answer: B. Explanation: Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Treaty-status sequence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. B. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. C. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. D. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Treaty-status sequence?

A. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. B. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. C. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. D. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies CBD three objectives?

A. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. B. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. C. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. D. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD three objectives?

A. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. B. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. C. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. D. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses CBD three objectives without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. B. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. C. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. D. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD three objectives?

A. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. B. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. C. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. D. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies CBD convention-protocol boundary?

A. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. B. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. C. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. D. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD convention-protocol boundary?

A. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. B. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. C. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. D. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.

Answer: B. Explanation: The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses CBD convention-protocol boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. B. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. C. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. D. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.

Answer: C. Explanation: The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD convention-protocol boundary?

A. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. B. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. C. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. D. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.

Answer: D. Explanation: The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Cartagena biosafety pathway?

A. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. B. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. C. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. D. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Cartagena biosafety pathway?

A. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. B. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. C. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. D. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Cartagena biosafety pathway without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. B. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. C. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. D. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cartagena biosafety pathway?

A. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. B. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. C. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. D. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste

or pesticide treaty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Nagoya ABS pathway?

A. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. B. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. C. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. D. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Nagoya ABS pathway?

A. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. B. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. C. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. D. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Nagoya ABS pathway without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. B. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. C. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. D. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nagoya ABS pathway?

A. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. B. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. C. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. D. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies CBD COP framework boundary?

A. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. B. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. C. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. D. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control.

Answer: A. Explanation: A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CBD COP framework boundary?

A. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. B. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. C. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. D. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.

Answer: B. Explanation: A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses CBD COP framework boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. B. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. C. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. D. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.

Answer: C. Explanation: A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CBD COP framework boundary?

A. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. B. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. C. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. D. A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Basel PIC mechanism?

A. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. B. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. C. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. D. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel PIC mechanism?

A. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. B. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. C. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. D. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Basel PIC mechanism without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. B. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. C. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. D. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel PIC mechanism?

A. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. B. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. C. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. D. The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Basel Ban Amendment boundary?

A. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. B. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. C. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. D. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel Ban Amendment boundary?

A. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. B. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. C. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. D. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Basel Ban Amendment boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. B. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. C. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. D. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel Ban Amendment boundary?

A. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. B. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. C. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. D. The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Basel waste-listing boundary?

A. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. B. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. C. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. D. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated.

Answer: A. Explanation: Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Basel waste-listing boundary?

A. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. B. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. C. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. D. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.

Answer: B. Explanation: Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Basel waste-listing boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. B. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. C. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. D. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Basel waste-listing boundary?

A. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. B. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. C. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. D. Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control.

Answer: D. Explanation: Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Rotterdam cluster distinction?

A. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. B. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. C. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. D. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Rotterdam cluster distinction?

A. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. B. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. C. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. D. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Rotterdam cluster distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. B. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. C. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. D. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rotterdam cluster distinction?

A. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. B. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. C. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. D. The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Stockholm POP identity?

A. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. B. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. C. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. D. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Stockholm POP identity?

A. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. B. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. C. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. D. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Stockholm POP identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. B. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. C. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. D. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Stockholm POP identity?

A. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. B. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. C. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. D. Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. The

other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Stockholm annex functions?

A. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. B. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. C. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. D. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.

Answer: A. Explanation: Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Stockholm annex functions?

A. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. B. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. C. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. D. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.

Answer: B. Explanation: Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Stockholm annex functions without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. B. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. C. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. D. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery.

Answer: C. Explanation: Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Stockholm annex functions?

A. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. B. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. C. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. D. Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies POPRC-to-COP sequence?

A. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. B. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. C. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. D. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of POPRC-to-COP sequence?

A. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. B. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. C. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. D. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses POPRC-to-COP sequence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. B. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. C. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. D. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about POPRC-to-COP sequence?

A. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. B. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. C. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. D. Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?

A. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. B. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. C. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. D. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?

A. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. B. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. C. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. D. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Vienna-Montreal hierarchy without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. B. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. C. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. D. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Vienna-Montreal hierarchy?

A. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. B. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. C. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. D. The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Montreal control object?

A. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. B. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. C. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. D. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Montreal control object?

A. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. B. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. C. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. D. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Montreal control object without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. B. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. C. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. D. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Montreal control object?

A. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. B. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. C. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. D. The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Kigali HFC boundary?

A. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. B. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. C. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. D. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Kigali HFC boundary?

A. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. B. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. C. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. D. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Kigali HFC boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. B. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. C. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. D. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Kigali HFC boundary?

A. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. B. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. C. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. D. The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Montreal implementation support?

A. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. B. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. C. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. D. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Montreal implementation support?

A. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. B. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. C. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. D. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Montreal implementation support without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. B. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. C. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. D. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Montreal implementation support?

A. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. B. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. C. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. D. The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Decision-obligation boundary?

A. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. B. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. C. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. D. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment.

Answer: A. Explanation: A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Decision-obligation boundary?

A. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. B. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. C. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. D. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete.

Answer: B. Explanation: A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Decision-obligation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. B. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. C. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. D. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.

Answer: C. Explanation: A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Decision-obligation boundary?

A. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. B. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. C. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. D. A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have

different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Answer: D. Explanation: A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Current evidence boundary?

A. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. B. CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. C. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. D. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete.

Answer: A. Explanation: Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Current evidence boundary?

A. Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. B. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. C. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. D. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.

Answer: B. Explanation: Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Current evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. B. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. C. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. D. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty.

Answer: C. Explanation: Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current evidence boundary?

A. The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. B. The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. C. The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. D. Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date.

Answer: D. Explanation: Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED CBD, BIOSAFETY, ABS, WASTE, POP AND OZONE PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route biodiversity, ABS, HFC and hazardous-chemical demands to this comparative owner. Unavailable or provisional objective keys are not inferred, and treaty names are not treated as answers.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: correctly match each convention (CBD, Basel, Stockholm, Montreal) to its precise, non-overlapping subject matter and key mechanism.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the Montreal Protocol's success factors (binding timelines, finance/technology transfer, universal ratification) are used as a template when discussing what makes multilateral environmental agreements effective.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.

Answer-key rule: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	17	Biodiversity variation in India and Biological Diversity Act 2002	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	20	Hydrofluorocarbons uses aerosols foam fire retardants lubricants	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	59	Mercury pollution sources gold mining coal plants health	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	79	Biodiversity Management Committees Nagoya Protocol access benefit sharing	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Biodiversity variation in India and Biological Diversity Act 2002
- Hydrofluorocarbons uses aerosols foam fire retardants lubricants
- Mercury pollution sources gold mining coal plants health
- Biodiversity Management Committees Nagoya Protocol access benefit sharing

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

11. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on convention-specific mechanisms (Basel's prior-informed-consent, Stockholm's POPs Review Committee, Montreal's Multilateral Fund) should be answered by applying each convention's precise institutional mechanism rather than generic treaty knowledge.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers comparing "why some multilateral environmental agreements succeed more than others" should explicitly use the Montreal Protocol's disaggregated success-factor table (Section 2) as the analytical framework.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	17	Biodiversity variation in India and Biological Diversity Act 2002	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Biodiversity variation in India and Biological Diversity Act 2002

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III

Demand: Discuss biodiversity variation in India and the Biological Diversity Act.

Status: Verified routed demand; domestic biodiversity governance is cross-owned by Topic 04.

Model solution: CBD three objectives: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **CBD convention-protocol boundary:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Nagoya ABS pathway:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **CBD COP framework boundary:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Current evidence boundary:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: CBD three objectives: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **CBD convention-protocol boundary:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Nagoya ABS pathway:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **CBD COP framework boundary:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Current evidence boundary:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Discuss biodiversity variation in India and the Biological Diversity Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed demand; domestic biodiversity governance is cross-owned by Topic 04. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: CBD three objectives: The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone

is incomplete. **CBD convention-protocol boundary:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Nagoya ABS pathway:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **CBD COP framework boundary:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Current evidence boundary:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Differentiate the CBD, Basel, Stockholm and Vienna-Montreal regimes. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD three objectives. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed

ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.
- The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete.
- The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.
- Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.
- The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.
- The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD three objectives. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary,

measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Differentiate the CBD, Basel, Stockholm and Vienna-Montreal regimes. Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD three objectives. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism.

Named evidence/example: The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim: Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vienna-Montreal hierarchy.

Named evidence/example: The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or

legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD three objectives. **Named evidence/example:** The Convention on Biological Diversity combines conservation, sustainable use and fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic-resource utilisation; conservation alone is incomplete. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for

ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Differentiate the CBD, Basel, Stockholm and Vienna-Montreal regimes. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the Cartagena and Nagoya Protocols. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cartagena biosafety pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Nagoya ABS pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.
- The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty.
- The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cartagena biosafety pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Nagoya ABS pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish the Cartagena and Nagoya Protocols. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cartagena biosafety pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Nagoya ABS pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale,

stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cartagena biosafety pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Cartagena Protocol governs safe transfer, handling and use of living modified organisms with transboundary-movement procedures; it is not a general hazardous-waste or pesticide treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Nagoya ABS pathway. **Named evidence/example:** The Nagoya Protocol concerns access to genetic resources, prior informed consent or mutually agreed terms as applicable, and fair benefit-sharing; it must not be confused with biosafety approval. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish the Cartagena and Nagoya Protocols. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain Basel's PIC system and Ban Amendment boundary. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's

ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel waste-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade.
- The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.
- Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control.
- The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel waste-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain Basel's PIC system and Ban Amendment boundary. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel waste-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Basel PIC mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Convention controls covered transboundary waste movements through prior informed consent and environmentally sound management

duties; the original Convention is not an undifferentiated ban on all waste trade. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel waste-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Hazardous, other, plastic and electronic waste claims depend on the applicable annex, amendment, contamination condition and national rule; a material name alone does not settle treaty control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain Basel's PIC system and Ban Amendment boundary. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain Stockholm POP listing and annex controls. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm annex functions. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary.

Named evidence/example: A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing.
- Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated.
- Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.
- A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm annex functions. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain Stockholm POP listing and annex controls. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm annex functions. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal

link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Stockholm POP identity. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm targets chemicals characterised by persistence, bioaccumulation, adverse effects and long-range environmental transport; toxicity alone does not establish a POP listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stockholm annex functions. **Named evidence/example:** Stockholm Annex A concerns elimination, Annex B restriction and Annex C unintentional production, subject to treaty-specific exemptions or measures; annex placement must be source-dated. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic

Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain Stockholm POP listing and annex controls. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess why the Montreal architecture is institutionally distinctive. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal implementation support. **Named evidence/example:** The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it.
- The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty.
- The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.
- The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery.
- A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal implementation support. **Named evidence/example:** The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess why the Montreal architecture is institutionally distinctive. Answer in about 300...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental

mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal implementation support. **Named evidence/example:** The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Vienna-Montreal hierarchy. **Named evidence/example:** The Vienna Convention is the framework convention for ozone-layer protection, while the Montreal Protocol is the operative substance-control protocol under it. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal control object. **Named evidence/example:** The Montreal Protocol controls production and consumption of listed ozone-depleting substances through differentiated schedules and adjustments or amendments; it is not a generic greenhouse-gas treaty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montreal implementation support. **Named evidence/example:** The Multilateral Fund and treaty institutions support developing-country implementation, but a finance mechanism or approved project does not itself prove national compliance or atmospheric recovery. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Decision-obligation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A proposed listing, review recommendation, draft decision, adopted COP decision, treaty amendment and domestic notification have different legal effects and must be cited at the correct level. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess why the Montreal architecture is institutionally distinctive. Answer in about 300...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Build a status-disciplined comparative answer on the four treaty systems. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Treaty-status sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD COP framework boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged.
- Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment.
- The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks.
- A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome.

- The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control.
- The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes.
- Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses.
- The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately.
- Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Treaty-status sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD COP framework boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete

ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Build a status-disciplined comparative answer on the four treaty systems. Answer in about 300...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Treaty-status sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD COP framework boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named**

evidence/example: The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured

parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

7. **Claim and named evidence:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
9. **Claim and named evidence:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Treaty-scope map. **Named evidence/example:** CBD addresses biodiversity, Basel controls transboundary movements and disposal of covered wastes, Stockholm controls persistent organic pollutants, and the Vienna-Montreal regime protects the ozone layer through substance controls; their scopes must not be merged. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Treaty-status sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Adoption, signature, ratification or accession, entry into force, amendment acceptance and domestic implementation are separate stages; a COP decision is not automatically a treaty amendment. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD convention-protocol boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The CBD is the parent convention, while the Cartagena Protocol addresses biosafety and living modified organisms and the Nagoya Protocol addresses access and benefit-sharing; protocol participation and obligations require separate status checks. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CBD COP framework boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A global biodiversity framework or COP decision guides collective implementation under the CBD, but adoption of a target does not prove national legal incorporation, finance or achieved ecological outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Basel Ban Amendment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Basel Ban Amendment is a later strengthening with its own scope and entry-into-force history; it must be distinguished from the Convention's general consent-based movement control. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rotterdam cluster distinction. **Named evidence/example:** The Rotterdam Convention applies prior informed consent to trade in listed hazardous chemicals and pesticides and is jointly administered with Basel and

Stockholm, but administrative clustering does not merge treaty scopes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** POPRC-to-COP sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific review by the Persistent Organic Pollutants Review Committee precedes a Conference of the Parties listing decision; nomination, recommendation, adoption and entry into force are distinct statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Kigali HFC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Kigali Amendment phases down hydrofluorocarbons because of climate impact even though HFCs do not deplete ozone; phase-down is not phase-out and Kigali status must be checked separately. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Party counts, ratification status, current annex listings, COP outcomes, fund figures, national obligations and implementation results require the relevant secretariat or official national source and date. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Build a status-disciplined comparative answer on the four treaty systems. Answer in about 300...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.